

Vertigo



April Section Night – Cerro Torre (Daniel Joll)

Section News

April Section Night

Daniel Joll returns to Wellington for our April section night kicking off at 6pm on 1 March at the Southern Cross on Abel Smith Street. Dan will take us on the Ragni route of Cerro Torre which he climbed in the last week of February. He'll also give us a quick summary of his recent NZ Alpine Team trip to Canada.

May Section Night

South Island traverse 2016/17

Alexis Belton was a member of the team who carried out a South Island traverse recently. Alexis will show a presentation and talk about the team's 4 month traverse of the South Island of New Zealand from Cape Farewell to Foveaux Strait.



Lake Poteriteri



Frew Saddle

Come hear about the highs and lows of life on the tour in the mountains of the South Island during the wettest summers in years. Travelling mostly by foot, but also by bike, kayak and packraft, our route took us through the undervalued splendours Kahurangi, the mighty South Alps and the depths of south-western Fiordland.

Please don't forget the koha for section night – there'll be an ice bucket at the entry door for that purpose. ☺

Chairs Report March 2017

I've recently received the NZAC membership survey results and you might be interested in the following.

- Wellington Section had 472 members at last count.
- We get between 30 and 60 members at our monthly section nights and anywhere from 4 to 20 members on section trips.
- Nearly half (218) of us are 50 or older.
- More than half (300) are 40 or older.
- 390 are 30 or older which leaves only 82 of us under 30.
- Our youngest member is two (a family member).
- 17 members are under 18 leaving 65 members between 19 and 30 years old.
- The majority of members on section trips are under 30.

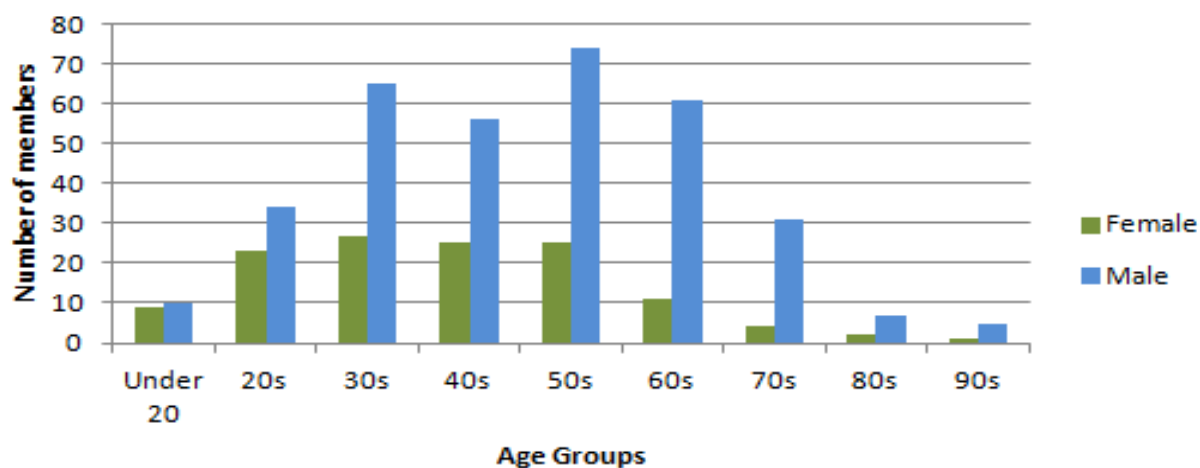
I don't know how many in the 30 and above bracket use other NZAC services and facilities but one thing is clear, they aren't very involved in section activities. So what do they do? If you're reading this, what do you do? Maybe you hang out with your old mates (I would if I had any), and drool over the monthly Vertigo.

I don't have enough data to look at any trends but I'd say that all those over 50 started out climbing back in their 20s. I don't know what the membership profile looked like back then but I'm guessing it didn't look like the table below.

The table shows that our membership is mostly older men and younger women, with a split around the age of 50. For some reason the women appear to discontinue their membership in their 50s while more men join then.

What is it that we, and that includes you, need to do to get more young members and particularly young females responding to the call of the alps?

Wellington Section membership by age and gender



If you have any comments on what you liked or didn't like send an email to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or tweet us @NZACWellington or post a message on our facebook page www.facebook.com/nzacwellington.

Finally: "One of the things that limits our learning is our belief that we already know something."
David Marquet

Simon
Chair: NZAC Wellington

For quick access to the section's page on the NZAC website, scan the below QR code.



Gear Hire

Don't forget the section has gear for hire : avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, hammers, helmets, crampons, probes and PLBs. If you're keen to hire some gear please fill in the form [here](#). Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on its return. The section is continuing to upgrade gear with new helmets, crampons and a couple of entry level ice hammers among the more recent purchases.

A little bit of advance notice would be appreciated as gear often needs to be retrieved from the gear store in Lower Hutt. Gear collections and drop-offs are usually available in the city during the working day or at section night.

Upcoming Trips, Courses and Events

Wellington Section Trips and Courses

All our planned South Island trips come with the added bonus that rental vehicle costs are covered by the section. If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or know more email us on wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the committee can help with advertising / logistics.

When?	Where?
Easter	Mystery mountain – South Westland – being led by Don French – see details below
21-23 July	Beginner level Snowcraft course – Mt Ruapehu
28-30 July	Beginner level Snowcraft course – Mt Ruapehu
18-20 August	Beginner / Intermediate level Snowcraft course – Mt Ruapehu
25-27 August	Intermediate / Advanced level Snowcraft course – Mt Ruapehu
Labour Weekend – 21-23 October	Mt Hopeless, Nelson Lakes
November	Aspiring Take 2

Easter trip – magical mystery mountain

This trip leaves Wellington on the afternoon of Wednesday, 12th April and returns on Sunday 23rd April.

Objective: G (name withheld for reasons that will become obvious)

Height: Just over 2000ms

Location: South Westland

Trip leader: Don French

Dates:

- Ex-Wellington: Wednesday 12th April (Car on Ferry)
- Enter Mountains: Friday 14th
- Intended Summit Day: Sunday 16th
- Other objectives: Monday 17th to Friday 21st
- Exit mountains: Saturday 22nd
- Return Wellington: PM Sunday 23rd

Background: The mountain is a short distance from road. Tracked at first with a hut. 2nd approach day will involve a considerable amount of off track work to a high camp. The climb will be mixed, with rock and snow. Probably no more than 4 to 6 pitches of rock, followed by snow to the summit. Difficulty unknown.

The mountain was first climbed in 1952. Don (and others) have not been able to find any record of subsequent ascents. It has been attempted many times. The mountain has never been

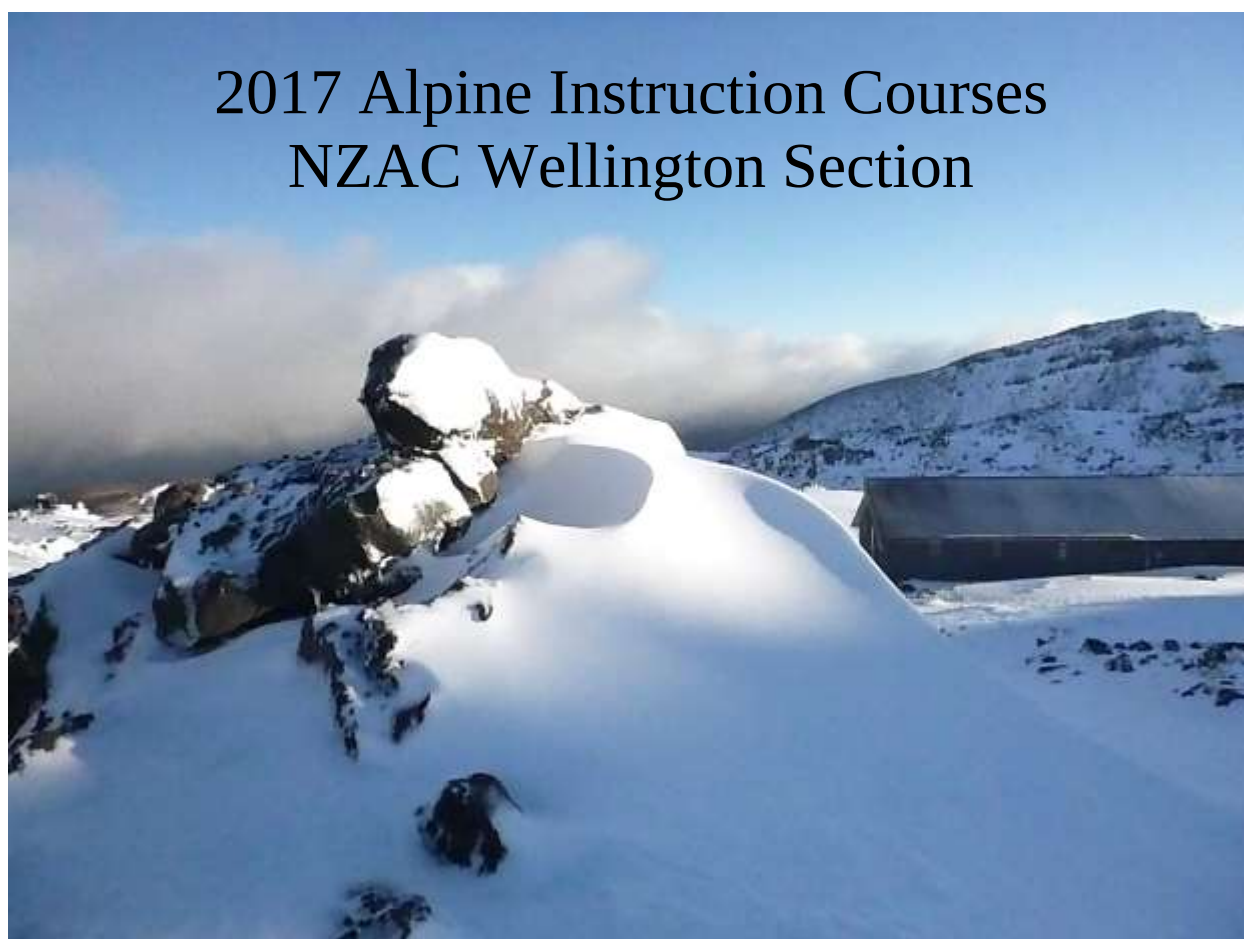
climbed from this side.

More information (pictures, maps etc) will be released once team is confirmed.

Climber Requirements: Some mountaineering experience, multiday trip experience and some off track experience. Rock skills to grade 16.

For more information, email: don@french.net.nz Mobile: 027 445 2980

2017 Snowcraft Courses



When?

21-23 July	Beginner Course
28-30 July	Beginner Course
18-20 August	Beginner / Intermediate Courses
25-27 August	Intermediate / Advanced Courses

Where?

Whakapapa skifield, Mt Ruapehu

How much?

\$270 – includes accommodation, food and instruction

What's it about?

Choose the Beginner level course if you've had little to no experience in an alpine environment. The focus is on personal preparation and safe movement on snow. If you have a bit of experience in alpine terrain and are looking for an entry-level course in mountaineering come along to an Intermediate Snowcraft Course. This course introduces the use of ropes, harnesses and anchors required for protection when travelling in steeper terrain. If you've spent some time in an alpine environment and you're comfortable with using ropes and building snow anchors then the Advanced course develops further techniques in mountaineering to access more routes.

Course Structure

The practical component of each course is run over a weekend arriving at the lodge on Ruapehu on a Friday night and departing the mountain mid-afternoon on the Sunday. There's a theory evening held in Wellington on the Thursday night a week before the weekend away. The theory evening will cover gear requirements, logistics, weather and risk. The section has some of the gear you'll need available for hire at \$20 for the weekend, including helmets, ice axes, crampons and avalanche equipment.

Register your interest [here](#) or send your questions via email to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz – you'll be sent the registration form to complete.

BANFF Mountain Film Festival 2017



That time of the year is coming up fast – movies from the BANFF Mountain Film Festival will be screening at the Paramount Theatre in Wellington in May and June. We have two programmes of movies to screen and two dates have been set for each programme as follows :

Programme A : 6:00pm Tuesday May 30th
6:00pm Wednesday June 14th
Programme B : 6:00pm Wednesday June 7th
1:00pm Sunday June 25th

Tickets are not yet on sale and the programme is not available on the banff.nz website yet – keep an eye on the website, your email and Facebook for updates.

Outdoor Training NZ Courses

OTNZ Wellington are running training courses as follows:

- Advanced bushcraft (5-7 May) - \$100
- Risk Management (24-25 June) - \$70

More information on these courses and how to book your place can be found on <http://www.outdoortraining.nz/courses/courses.php>.

Notices

2017 Remarkables Ice and Mixed Climbing Festival – 17-20 August

The Remarkables Ice and Mixed Climbing Festival is the annual climbing meet of the Expedition Climbers Club Incorporated. This festival :

- Brings together a huge cross section of climbers from around NZ and the world. Beginners get to rub shoulders and share the rope with the top winter alpine climbers in NZ.
- Offers clinics, competitions, races and social gatherings to advance and promote modern mixed climbing.
- Showcases the new and existing route potential on NZ's most accessible multi-pitch winter training area, the Remarkables.
- Shares local knowledge and forms new climbing partnerships.
- Fundraises for the ECC Expedition Capital Fund.

You need to be a club member to attend this event. Those who wish to join can visit the registration page of [this website](#). You can join the club and register for a clinic all on one simple form.

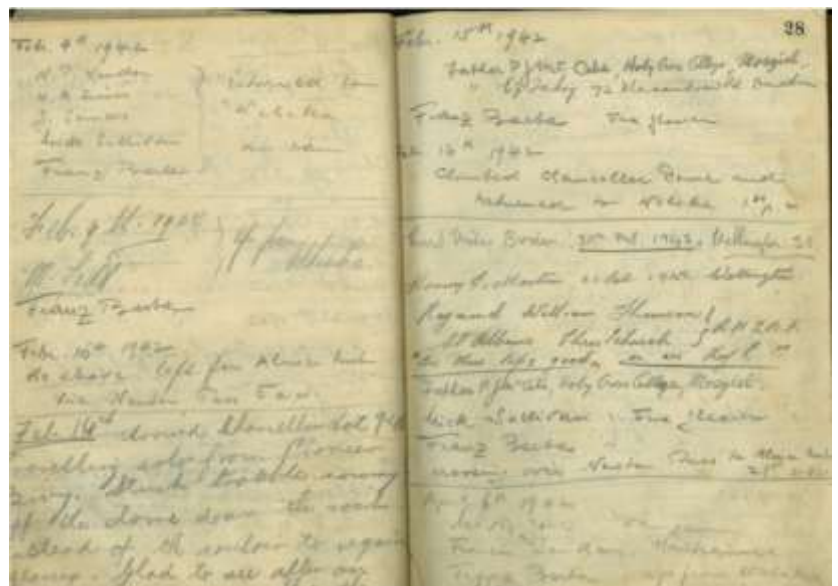
Information on the event can be found at www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz

Hut Log Books

The New Zealand Alpine Club greatly values its hut log books and over the years these have been added to the NZAC Collection at the Hocken Archives. Many have gone missing from huts over the years however and that leaves us with gaps in our history that we would like to fill.

Should you find any old hut log books stored and forgotten we would greatly like to see them returned. Even if the log books aren't strictly from NZAC huts, better they are archived than lost.

Image featured is from the Chancellor Hut Log Book 1940-1956.



Please send through to Margaret McMahon, NZAC, PO Box 786, Christchurch 8140 as we need to properly catalogue them before they are sent to the Hocken for indexing.

Fluoro Block Party in New Plymouth 9 July

The YMCA Taranaki and The Crux Climbing Gym are running New Zealand's first Black Light Pump Fest Style Bouldering Competition on Sunday 9 July (first weekend of the school holidays). For more information about this fun event, click [here](#).

Tasman Valley Hut Maintenance Complete

Department of Conservation Senior Ranger, David Dittmer, reports that the Tasman Saddle Hut maintenance project is now complete and the hut is open again for alpine visitors.



Further Faster – 15% discount to members



FURTHERFASTER

FurtherFaster is a New Zealand based distributor of quality clothing and equipment for outside adventures for you, your family and dogs. This new discount is available to members off their purchase total, excluding sale items and kayaks. Online discount code available to members when logged in. See

website for details: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/company/further-faster/>

Wellington Section 2017 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Position	Name	Contact
Chairperson	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Co Chair	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Treasurer (Acting)	Peter Laurensen	
Secretary & Vertigo editor	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Patron	John Nankervis	
Other Committee Members	Elisha Watson	
	Matt Pemberton	
	Sandy Britain	
	Alex Waterford	
Rock Drill Overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 55 55 893

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* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



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